Chapter 12

The Two Boys and the Lions

SUMMARY. The god had two sons, !Xuma and Kha‖'an. The boys went hunting and killed an eland. Lions came and killed the boys in turn, and buried them in the eland's stomach contents (chyme). The father was helped to track the boys by a turtle who put his head into the coals of the fires they had made along their journey. At the last fire the coals were hot, and the turtle's head was burned, so they knew the eland's death place was nearby. When they reached it, the god immediately saw that his sons were buried in the chyme, but pretended he couldn't see them. He asked pied babbler birds and other birds to sing, but the boys didn't come out of the chyme. Then he asked all the animals in turn to dance, but his children still did not emerge. So he hung a meteor, "this fire that hangs in the sky and kills people", up in a tree. When he called the meteor down onto the eland's death place, it blasted through the chyme and !Xuma and Kha‖'an jumped out. They cooked the eland meat and ate well. They took the rest of the meat home and the lions had none.

SPEAKER. *|Xoan N!a'an*

RECORDED. Kauri, Botswana, 1971

TRANSCRIBED BY. *Beesa Crystal Boo, Tsamkxao Fanni |Ui, Hacky Kgami Gcao, |Ai!ae Fridrick |Kunta*

ka n|ui cete o
another one is
haa, ha hin ‖'a ha ‖'aiha
[2] *he, this one who was god*

haa ǁ'aiha ǁ'a ha mhisi, !Xuma keti... ha ǁ'aiha ǁ'a ha mhisi
god's sons, !Xuma and... god's sons
!Xuma
!Xuma
te o Khaǁ'an
and Khaǁ'an
ehee
yes
te ǁ'a da'abi sa to'a tse
and those children then
u !aqe
went hunting
ha mhisi
his sons
te tse u !hun n!ang
and they went and killed an eland
inn
yes
te tse,tse tza ha khoea
and went, went and slept (where it died)
te tse ku du ha
and then were doing it
te du ha te
and doing it
haa n!hai
the lion
haa n!hai ǁ'a ha tse
the lion then
ha tse
he then
ha tse tsi g|ae, tsi g|ae !'oan sa
he then came, came and killed them
ee, !'oan sa waqn toan si
yes, killed both of them
te haa n!ang g!u zi ha tse !oma sa
and he buried the two in the eland's stomach contents
ee
yes
ǁ'a ha tse gea ǁ'akoa te tse ku 'm ka !ha
then he came and stayed there and then was eating the meat
ee
yes

te ha ba tse
and his father then
si!a ba tse ge te kxoa ha kxoa si kxoa si kxoa si kxoa si kxoa si
their father then looked for him, looked for them, looked for them, looked for them, looked for them
ǀoa ho si
didn't find them
ee
yes
te ǁa'i nǀui nǀhui si
and one day took them
te !'oahn si te ko zam sin te
and opened them–and there were turtles
ǁo'a sin te
and tortoises and
tcisi waqn to'an si sin te
all these things and
ǁae si
took them
te si!a tse ku ǀoo si
and they all followed them
sa !uh
their track
ǁxam ǁxam ka tsi se koa sa tza
went along and went along and came and saw where they had slept
ka ha !oa zam ka ko
then he told the turtle and said
"ǀ'u a nǀai ko
put your head in
koa ke ko
here, in the
da'a hee
fire here
da'a he re hi n!ang ǂa'u?"
is the inside of this fire cool?"
ka zam tsi gǀae ǀ'u ha nǀai
and the turtle came and put his head
ka ko "hia he o hia hi n!ang...
and said "this fire's inside is...
te hi n!ang ǀoa khui te ǁ'un"
but its inside isn't hot but warm"
ka ko,"ee, hia he o hia goaq si
and said, "yes, this one is the one that long ago they

sa ǁama khuin to'a sa tsi tza khuin ke"
they two came from here and came and slept here"
ka si!a ce ka to'a ka u ka u ka u ka u ka u ka u ka
then they again went there and went and went and went and went and went and went and
u ho yaa da'a n|ui
went and saw another fire
ehee
yes
ka ha u, ha u !huia ha n|ai ko hi n!ang
then he went, he went and stuck his head into its center
ka ha ko, "nǁaq'aa,
and he said, "(onomatop.),
mi n|ai ku'u !ai
my head is burning to death
mi cu"
I'm going to lie down"
ha zam koe nǁae ka !huia cu ha n|ai ko ka kxa, ka sin ko "ee,
the turtle thus said and squeezed down his head against the ground and just said "aha,
koa ke re sa goaq‡'an tza?"
did they sleep here yesterday?"
ha koe se kxui
he thus looked around
ka !oa si!a ka ka
and told them that
ka |oe g|ae cu ka u
they should just go together
|oe ku ko ka ku ko
just do thus and do thus
ha ǁxam te ua ua ha n!ang n|ui
he went along and went went to the eland 's death place
te "yaa da'abi re gea kore?
and "where are the children?
mi mhsi haa !Xuma sa Khaǁ'an re gea kore?
where are my children !Xuma and Khaǁ'an?
(okaa ha za'a se he !'han)
(it was that he had already seen and knew)
"haa !Xuma sa Khaǁ'an re gea kore?"
"where are !Xuma and Khaǁ'an?"
"e sa |oa !'han !Xuma sa Khaǁ'an"
"we are those who don't know !Xuma and Khaǁ'an"
ha tsi g|ae se te se te se tama
he came and looked and looked and didn't find

ǁ'akaa ha kua
and then he quickly
ha, hatce re a te !'han tcisa ke o g!kauce he ku ko "tcaqu,kaquu,kaquu"?
he, what is, you know those things that are pied babblers (birds) here that say "(onomatop.)"?
ee
yes
ǁ'akaa ha
so that he
kua n|hui ǁ'akaa sa te ko, " tcaq'aba, baq'a,baq'a, baq'a"
quickly took those things that said "(onomatop.)"
te tci n|ui |oa hui si
but nothing helped them
te ha n|hui ǁ'a si sa te g|ae n!o'an u
and he took those things and went and threw them away
n!o'an u
threw them away
te ko
and said
"mi,mi mhisi re mi ca ku ho?
"my, my children will I ever see?
ka ke hi kuriha ǁoeh !ao..."
that they long ago thus died..."
ee
yes
te ǁ'akaa ha
and then he
ha ku gu ha he ka n‡ai djxania ha
he took this one and made him dance
ka ha mhisi |oa g!a'i
but his children didn't come out
ka ha gu ha he, ka n‡ai djxania ha
and he took this one, and made him dance
ee, ka ha mhisi
yes, but his children
|oa g!a'i, ka ha gu ha he ka n‡ai djxania ka ha mhisi |oa g!a'i
didn't come out, so he took this one and made him dance but his children didn't come out
te ha tsi g|ae
and he came
du yaa, du yaa da'a ku ǁ'ua n|a'an
did the, did the fire that hangs in the sky

he hi hin to'a he ku !hun ju
this fire here that kills people
mi he
I here
ǁ'akaa ha du ha
then he did it
ee
yes
ǂaeha ka tci n!a'an n|a te ju ka...
went to that big thing there of course and people were...
"|aqin-|aqin-|aqin-|aqi-|aqin
"(onomatop.)
|aqan-|aqan, taa tia khuian
(onomatop.), I'm like this
|aqan-|aqan, taa tia khuian
(onomatop.), I'm like this
|aqa-|aqa, taa tia khuian"
(onomatop.), I'm like this'
aie
mother
te yaa da'a
and the fire
yaa da'a khaua te ǁ'a n|uia hin to'a ha ko
the fire (meteor) came down at the death-place (of the eland) there and he said
"ho koh"
(expression of excitement|aggression)
te nǂa'm gǂhu
and (it) knocked-smeared
te ha ko "|aqe
and he said "(onomatop.)
|aqe |aqe
(onomatop.)
g!aq'i tzau |'hain |'hain |'hau
(lisping nonsense speech of the god)
|'hain|'hain |'aoro" ka ha ko ha mhsi g!a'i
(more lisping speech) and that's how he said his two children should come out
te ha da'aabi, ha !Xuma sa Khaǁ'an khu g!a'i
and his children, !Xuma and Khaǁ'an jumped out
ee
yes
te ha tah ko "|'hain
and he himself said "(onomatop.)

ǁ’a tcia khoe
so things are like that
itsa m, !Xuma sa Khaǁ’an,
you two, !Xuma and Khaǁ’an,
ǀoa g!a’i nǀang
(why) don’t you come out so that
e!a u nǀhui !ha u te ku du
(lisping) (why) don’t we take the meat and leave and do
ǁ’a ju te g!a’i te
then the people came out and
ǁ’a kahin si nǀhui !ha te
then they took the meat and
ka ǁau nǀang te ’m !ha te ju nǀoa
they sat well and ate meat and people cooked
!ha te ha ’m te ’m te
meat and he ate and ate and
si nǀhui !ha te ǁ’a si te gǀae u
they took the meat and then they went off
n‡au u ka tjuǀho
went home to their village
ee
yes
tcisa ju !ae nǁaahn nǁae
things that the old people long ago told
hajuin mi hin koh tsa’a?
from whom did I here hear it?
tci !ae ǀ’hoansi
true old things